

Fergus the Frog Finds His Croak

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Fergus was a tiny green frog. He lived on a lily pad in Bluebell Pond. Every evening, the frogs sang a pond song. Big frogs croaked deep. Medium frogs croaked round. "Brum brum! Brum brum!" But when Fergus tried, only a squeak came out. "Meep," said Fergus. He tried again. "Meep." The big frogs chuckled. Fergus felt embarrassed. His cheeks turned red. "I cannot sing the pond song," he said. He hopped behind a tall reed. He felt left out. He felt small.



His friend Lottie the ladybug landed beside him. She had heard everything. "Why are you hiding, Fergus?" she asked. "My croak is wrong," said Fergus. "It is too squeaky." "It does not belong." Lottie shook her tiny head. "Every sound belongs," she said. "Listen to me." "Every croak belongs in the song." "Every croak belongs in the song." Fergus repeated it quietly. "Every croak belongs in the song." It became his hopeful words. "Every croak belongs in the song."



Lottie had an idea. "Sing your meep for me," she said. "Just for me." Fergus took a breath. "Meep," he sang. Lottie clapped her wings. "Again!" she said. "Meep meep!" sang Fergus. It sounded like tiny bells. Lottie buzzed with joy. "That is the prettiest part!" she said. "You can be the twinkle in the song." Fergus felt hopeful. He felt special. His meep was not wrong. It was just different.



Can you meep like Fergus? Try it: meep meep! Now sing it like tiny bells: meep meep meep! That evening, the pond choir gathered. The big frogs began. "Brum brum! Brum brum!" Then Fergus hopped forward. "Meep meep!" he sang. His tiny bells fit perfectly. Brum meep brum meep. The song sounded even better. The big frogs smiled. "Our twinkle!" they croaked. Fergus sang all evening.



When the moon rose, the song grew soft. Fergus rested on his lily pad. Lottie snuggled under a petal. "You were the best twinkle," she whispered. Fergus smiled. "Meep," he yawned softly. The pond water rocked gently. The stars hummed a quiet tune. And Fergus fell into a sweet, musical sleep.

***Moral:** Every voice, big or small, makes the song complete.*

The End